DBT PORTFOLIO PROJECT

LAYER: CONFIGURATION

DBT Project Configuration

YAML | dbt_project.yml | Materialization | Schema Routing | Project Setup

Project Summary

The master configuration file for the entire DBT healthcare analytics project. Defines project name, version, folder structure (models, tests, seeds, macros), and materialization defaults per schema -- routing healthcare models to tables and demo models to views. All downstream model behavior is governed by this file.

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1 PROJECT OVERVIEW

File:	dbt_project.yml
Layer:	Configuration (project root)
Purpose:	Master project blueprint -- schema routing, materialization defaults, folder paths
Schemas Configured:	healthcare (table), demo (view)
Materialization Default:	view (overridden per folder)
Audience:	DBT developers, Data Engineers, Analytics Engineers

2 BUSINESS CONTEXT

This file establishes the governance layer for the entire analytics project. By centralizing materialization and schema settings here, individual model files stay clean -- they only override config when they deviate from the standard. The healthcare schema is materialized as tables for query performance; the demo schema uses views to keep development flexible without consuming storage.

- healthcare schema: all models materialize as tables -- optimized for Tableau and Power BI consumption.
- demo schema: views keep sandbox/development work lightweight.
- model-paths, test-paths, seed-paths all defined -- enforces standard dbt project layout.
- clean-targets removes target/ and dbt_packages/ on dbt clean, keeping the repo tidy.

3 TECHNICAL EXPLANATION

- name / version: Identifies the project for dependency resolution and documentation.
- profile: Links to the 'default' connection profile (Snowflake credentials, warehouse, DB).
- model-paths: ['models'] -- all .sql model files must live inside the models/ directory.
- target-path: 'target' -- compiled SQL and run artifacts land here (gitignored).
- models block: Nested YAML applies +materialized config per folder path. The + prefix denotes a dbt config key vs a folder name.
- healthcare_data_project.demo: +schema: demo, +materialized: view
- healthcare_data_project.healthcare: +schema: healthcare, +materialized: table

4 FULL CONFIGURATION FILE

```
name: 'my_new_project'
version: '1.0.0'
config-version: 2

profile: 'default'

model-paths: ["models"]
analysis-paths: ["analyses"]
test-paths: ["tests"]
seed-paths: ["seeds"]
macro-paths: ["macros"]
snapshot-paths: ["snapshots"]

target-path: "target"
clean-targets:
  - "target"
  - "dbt_packages"

models:
  my_new_project:
    example:
      +materialized: table

    healthcare_data_project:
      demo:
        +schema: demo
        +materialized: view
      healthcare:
        +schema: healthcare
        +materialized: table
```